

VINZENT FERFERS

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Portfolio:
v-ferfers.github.io/oceanvision

CURRENT WORK

08 / 2026 – 11 / 2026

SUBSIM - Marine Monitoring & Computer Vision
ERASMUS+ Sweden

- Skåne: Computer vision model training, image segmentation & automated habitat mapping
- Vasskant: Biodiverse waterfront development; monitoring design & ROV scouting (6 orgs, Skanska & Gothenburg)
- SeAnalytics: eDNA filtration, plankton & water sampling

EDUCATION

since 10 / 2024 — Master: **studying M. Sc. in Biological Oceanography**
Kiel University (CAU) - GEOMAR

10 / 2020 – 09 / 2025 — Bachelor: **B. Sc. in Biology**
Kiel University (CAU)

SCHOLARSHIPS & GRANTS:

- 3× Erasmus+ · Universities of the Azores (PT), Aberdeen (UK) & Gothenburg (SE)
- FYORD Grant · WASCAL-IV Floating University (RV Polarstern)
- 2× PROMOS (DAAD) · Luminocean (Indonesia) & UCSC (Chile)

FIELD OPERATIONS & SCIENTIFIC DIVING

since 07 / 2022

Research Vessel (RV) experience
GEOMAR Helmholtz-Centre for Ocean Research

WASCAL Floating University:
- West Africa–Europe expedition (FYORD Grant)
- RV Polarstern, RV Alkor, RV Littorina

Offshore sampling skills:
- CTD, Multinet, Van Veen Grab, Box Corer, ARGO-Float, Drop-down Camera, Weather balloon, Dredge, mini-ROV

since 06 / 2024

Supervisor for Scientific Diving Operations (KFT)
Geological Institute Kiel University

Management skills:
- conducting risk assessments and project planning
- ensuring permit and rescue chain coordination

since 08 / 2022

Scientific Diver (KFT)

Scientific diving skills:
- population disease surveys and reef-health assessments
- operational diver repairing underwater monitoring station
- seagrass meadow pore water sampling
- archaeological documentation of underwater section of UNESCO World Heritage Site

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

07 / 2023 – 08 / 2025

Research Assistant – Prof. Dr. Frank Melzner
B.Sc. Thesis
GEOMAR Helmholtz-Centre for Ocean Research

Ecophysiology:
- Investigated ocean-warming effects on *Asterias rubens* immune cells (flow cytometry) and *Vibrio spp.* abundance.

Monitoring:
- Monitored sea star wasting disease (SSWD) through snorkel and camera surveys.
- Co-author (preprint): *DOI: 10.64898/2026.01.16.699924*

04 / 2025 – 08 / 2025

Research Assistant – Dr. Mark Lenz / GAME

GEOMAR Helmholtz-Centre for Ocean Research

Communication skills:
- Gave lectures on light pollution at Kiel's marine science exhibition centre (50+ attendees)
- organised outreach events on microplastics

Marketing skills:
- developed and implemented social media strategies to optimise public presence

06 / 2023 – 03 / 2025

Research Assistant – Dr. Meike Stumpp in collaboration with Dr. Marian Hu

Zoological Institute Kiel University
Physiological Institute Kiel University

Animal culture skills:
- establishment and maintenance of whole life cycle rearing system for sea urchin *Lytechinus pictus* as a model organism
- maintaining sea urchin culture with up to 100 animals over 2 years
- seawater manipulations (filtration, alkalinity & salinity)

Scientific collaboration:
- knowledge exchange with culturing operation at Scripps Institution of Oceanography (San Diego), with 60 live animals transported to Germany

REPRESENTATION & VOLUNTEERING

since 12 / 2020

Student Representative

Kiel University – GEOMAR – FYORD

Evaluation skills:
- **FYORD steering committee:** Budget allocation - Grant evaluation - Master's representation
- appointment committee for new faculty positions
- active member in decision-making of student council of Biology and Biological Oceanography

08 / 2019 – 07 / 2020

Social Year

German Red Cross - Volunta, Colombia

Language teaching:
- assisted English lessons by teaching in Spanish, adapting explanations to different age groups (5–17 y.o.)

Project planning:
- Collaborated with local families and politicians to set up projects for first aid training and starting a local parkour group

INTERNATIONAL EXPERIENCE

Studied, worked, conducted field research and community projects across multiple countries and cultural contexts.

- Hawai'i, USA
- Kaukab, Israel
- Ciénega, Colombia
- Scotland, UK
- Banda Neira, Indonesia
- Azores, Portugal
- Gothenburg, Sweden

QUALIFICATIONS

- Data analysis (R / Python)
- Computer vision (YOLO)
- AI-aided app & web dev.
- Risk assessments
- Mapping (QGIS)
- Team coordination
- ROV piloting (FIFISH)
- BIIGLE annotation
- Intercultural communication
- Underwater documentation
- Reef health monitoring
- Ship safety training

HOBBIES

- Surfing
- Meeting Friends
- Artistic Gymnastics
- Running
- Dancing
- Diving / Swimming